Kerry Back

J. Howard Creekmore Professor of Finance and Professor of Economics
Jones Graduate School of Business · Rice University
kerry.e.back@rice.edu

Education

Ph.D., Economics — University of Kentucky, 1983
B.A., Economics — Western Kentucky University, 1978

Employment

Rice University — 2009 –
- J. Howard Creekmore Professor of Finance, 2009 –
- Professor of Economics, 2014 –
- Finance Area Ph.D. Coordinator, 2009 – 2026
- Finance Area Faculty Coordinator, 2023 – 2026
- Advisor to the Dean on A.I. Initiatives 2026 –

Texas A&M University — 2004–2009
- Jerry and Kay Cox Chair in Business and Thomas W. Leland Memorial Chair in Finance

Washington University in Saint Louis — 1989–2004
- Visiting Associate, Associate, and Professor of Finance, 1989–1996
- Vernon W. and Marion K. Piper Professor of Financial Economics, 1996–2004
- Senior Associate Dean, Academic Affairs, 1996–2001, 2002–2003

Indiana University — 1987–1990
- Associate Professor of Finance

University of Pennsylvania — 1988–1989
- Visiting Assistant Professor of Economics

Northwestern University — 1982–1987
- Assistant Professor of Economics

Books

1. Back, K., Liu, H., and M. Loewenstein, 2025, *Pricing and Hedging Derivative Securities*.
2. Back, K., 2016, *Asset Pricing and Portfolio Choice Theory*, Oxford University Press, 2nd ed.
3. Back, K., 2005, *A Course in Derivative Securities: Introduction to Theory and Computation*, Springer. Chinese translation by Shanghai People's Publishing House.

Refereed Articles

1. Back, K., Carlin, B., Kazempour, S. M., and C. Xie, forthcoming, "Discretionary Announcement Timing and Stock Returns," *Journal of Finance*.
2. Back, K., Crotty, K., and S. M. Kazempour, 2022, "Validity, Tightness, and Forecasting Power of Risk Premium Bounds," *Journal of Financial Economics*, **144**, 732–760.

3. Back, K., and P. Barton, 2022, "Mediation and Strategic Delay in Bargaining and Markets," *Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control*, **141**.

4. Back, K., Liu, R., and A. Teguia, 2020, "Signaling in OTC Markets: Benefits and Costs of Transparency," *Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis*, **55**, 47–75.

5. Back, K., Liu, R., and A. Teguia, 2019, "Increasing Risk Aversion and Life-Cycle Investing," *Mathematics and Financial Economics*, **13**, 287–302.

6. Back, K., Collin-Dufresne, P., Fos, V., Li, T., and A. Ljungqvist, 2018, "Activism, Strategic Trading, and Liquidity," *Econometrica*, **86**, 1431–1463.

7. Back, K., Crane, A., and K. Crotty, 2018, "Skewness Consequences of Seeking Alpha," *Review of Financial Studies*, **31**, 4720–4761.

8. Back, K., Crotty, K., and T. Li, 2018, "Identifying Information Asymmetry in Securities Markets," *Review of Financial Studies*, **31**, 2277–2325.

9. Back, K., and K. Crotty, 2015, "The Informational Role of Stock and Bond Volume," *Review of Financial Studies*, **28**, 1381–1427.

10. Back, K., 2014, "A Characterization of the Coskewness-Cokurtosis Pricing Model," *Economics Letters*, **125**, 219–222.

11. Back, K., and S. Baruch, 2013, "Strategic Liquidity Provision in Limit Order Markets," *Econometrica*, **81**, 363–392.

12. Back, K., and D. Paulsen, 2009, "Open Loop Equilibria and Perfect Competition in Option Exercise Games," *Review of Financial Studies*, **22**, 4531–4552.

13. Back, K., and S. Baruch, 2007, "Working Orders in Limit Order Markets and Floor Exchanges," *Journal of Finance*, **61**, 1589–1621.

14. Back, K., and S. Baruch, 2004, "Information in Securities Markets: Kyle Meets Glosten and Milgrom," *Econometrica*, **72**, 433–465.

15. Back, K., and J. Zender, 2001, "Auctions of Divisible Goods with Endogenous Supply," *Economics Letters*, **73**, 29–34.

16. Back, K., Cao, H., and G. Willard, 2000, "Imperfect Competition among Informed Traders," *Journal of Finance*, **55**, 2117–2155.

17. Dybvig, P. H., Rogers, L. C. G., and K. Back, 1999, "Portfolio Turnpikes," *Review of Financial Studies*, **12**, 165–195.

18. Back, K., and H. Pedersen, 1998, "Long-Lived Information and Intraday Patterns," *Journal of Financial Markets*, **1**, 385–402.

19. Back, K., and J. F. Zender, 1993, "Auctions of Divisible Goods: On the Rationale for the Treasury Experiment," *Review of Financial Studies*, **6**, 733–764.

20. Back, K., 1993, "Asymmetric Information and Options," *Review of Financial Studies*, **6**, 435–472.

21. Back, K., and D. P. Brown, 1993, "Implied Probabilities in GMM Estimators," *Econometrica*, **61**, 971–975.

22. Back, K., 1993, "Incomplete Markets and Individual Risks," *Economic Theory*, **3**, 35–42.

23. Back, K., and D. P. Brown, 1992, "GMM, Maximum Likelihood, and Nonparametric Efficiency," *Economics Letters*, **39**, 23–28.

24. Back, K., 1992, "Insider Trading in Continuous Time," *Review of Financial Studies*, **5**, 387–409.

25. Back, K., 1991, "Asset Pricing for General Processes," *Journal of Mathematical Economics*, **20**, 371–395.
26. Back, K., and S. R. Pliska, 1991, "On the Fundamental Theorem of Asset Pricing with an Infinite State Space," *Journal of Mathematical Economics*, **20**, 1–18.
27. Back, K., 1988, "Structure of Consumption Sets and Existence of Equilibria in Infinite Dimensional Spaces," *Journal of Mathematical Economics*, **17**, 39–49.
28. Back, K., 1988, "Convergence of Lagrange Multipliers and Dual Variables for Convex Optimization Problems," *Mathematics of Operations Research*, **13**, 74–79.
29. Back, K., and S. R. Pliska, 1987, "The Shadow Price of Information in Continuous Time Decision Problems," *Stochastics*, **22**, 151–186.
30. Back, K., 1987, "A Compact Space of Transitive Locally Non-Satiated Preference Relations," *Economics Letters*, **24**, 253–256.
31. Back, K., 1986, "Concepts of Similarity for Utility Functions," *Journal of Mathematical Economics*, **15**, 129–142.
32. Back, K., 1986, "Continuity of the Fenchel Transform of Convex Functions," *Proceedings of the American Mathematical Society*, **97**, 661–667.

Working Papers

1. Back, K., Cocquemas, F., Ekren, I., and A. Lioui, 2026, "Optimal Transport and Informed Trading in Securities Markets," R&R at *Operations Research*.
2. Back, K., Çelebi, O., Kakhbod, A., and A. M. Reppen, 2026, "Segmented Trading Markets."
3. Back, K., Ober, A., and S. Pruitt, 2025, "The Virtue of Complexity in Simple Economic Models."

Other Publications

1. Back, K., 2010, "Martingale Pricing," *Annual Review of Financial Economics*, **2**, 235–250.
2. Back, K., and S. Baruch, 2010, "The Kyle Model," in R. Cont, ed., *Encyclopedia of Quantitative Finance*, Wiley.
3. Back, K., 2004, "Incomplete and Asymmetric Information in Asset Pricing Theory," in M. Frittelli and W. Runggaldier, eds., *Stochastic Methods in Finance*, Lecture Notes in Mathematics, Springer.
4. Back, K., 1996, "Yield Curve Models: A Mathematical Review," in I. Nelkin, ed., *Option Embedded Bonds*, Irwin, 3–36.
5. Back, K., 1995, "Continuous Trading with Asymmetric Information and Imperfect Competition," in M. Davis et al., eds., *Mathematical Finance*, IMA Volumes, Springer-Verlag.
6. Back, K., 1994, "Review of *Dynamic Asset Pricing Theory* by Darrell Duffie," *Journal of Economic Literature*, **32**, 708–709.
7. Back, K., 1991, "Review of *Prices in Financial Markets* by Michael U. Dothan," *Review of Financial Studies*, **4**, 221–226.

Editorial Positions

Editor, Review of Financial Studies	1994–1997
Co-Editor, Finance and Stochastics	2001–2011
Associate Editor, Journal of Finance	2022–2025
Associate Editor, Mathematics and Financial Economics	2006–2021
Associate Editor, Review of Asset Pricing Studies	2015–2020
Associate Editor, Journal of Finance	2003–2012
Associate Editor, Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control	1995–1996
Associate Editor, Journal of Economic Theory	1993–1996
Associate Editor, Mathematical Finance	1990–1996
Associate Editor, Review of Financial Studies	1992–1994
Advisory Board, Finance and Stochastics	2012–2019
Advisory Board, FMA Survey and Synthesis Series	2012–2015

Ph.D. Committees Chaired and Initial Placements

Rice University

Patrick Blonien (Carnegie Mellon) · Seyed Mohammad Kazempour (LSU) · Paul Barton (SEC) · Alberto Teguia (University of British Columbia) · Ron Liu (University of Nebraska) · Morad Zekhnini (Tulane)

Texas A&M University

Philipp Illeditsch (Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania)

Washington University in St. Louis

Chris Yung (University of Colorado) · Tao Li (Chinese University of Hong Kong) · Shmuel Baruch (London Business School) · Hal Pedersen (Georgia State)

Teaching Awards

Financial Management Association Innovation in Teaching Award	2025
Financial Management Association Innovation in Teaching Award (with Kevin Crotty)	2023
Executive Masters in Manufacturing Management Reid Teaching Award, Olin School	2001
Executive M.B.A. Reid Teaching Award, Olin School	1999
Professional M.B.A. Reid Teaching Award, Olin School	1998
Executive M.B.A. Reid Teaching Award, Olin School	1997

Other Teaching Contributions

- JGSB Finance Ph.D. Coordinator, 2009–2026
- Learn Investments at Rice Business
- Advisor to Rice MBA teams that won the Chicago Quantitative Alliance Investment Challenge in 2021–22 and 2022–23.

Awards and Honors

Western Finance Association Keynote Speaker	2024
Member, Foundation for the Advancement of Research in Financial Economics	2018 –
Fellow of the Finance Theory Group	2017 –

Nominated for AFA Board of Directors	2016
Charles River Associates Prize for Best Paper in Corporate Finance, WFA	2014
"Liquidity and Governance" (with Tao Li and Alexander Ljungqvist)	
University of Kentucky Gatton School of Business Alumni Hall of Fame	2013
Jones Graduate School of Business Scholarship Excellence Award	2013, 2019
Mays Business School Outstanding Research Award	2007
Kentucky Economic Association Distinguished Economist	2000
Washington University Distinguished Faculty Member	1999
Best Paper in *Review of Financial Studies*	1993
"Asymmetric Information and Options"	
Batterymarch Fellow	1991–1992

Other Professional Activities

Distinguished Visiting Scholar, Securities and Exchange Commission	2015
Jon M. Huntsman Presidential Visiting Professor, Utah State University	2013–2014
AFA Editor Search Committee	2010–2011
AFA Director Nomination Committee	1994